

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with sustained practical experience supporting solicitors and fee earners across disputes, litigation and advisory work. Skilled in preparing and formatting legal documents and correspondence, organising and maintaining confidential case files, managing electronic bundles and court materials, and tracking deadlines across multiple live matters. Experienced across private practice (BCLP), in-house and clinic settings; consistently recognised for accuracy, reliability and the ability to work at pace under pressure.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis, legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules: Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, carrying partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared and formatted electronic hearing bundles, skeleton arguments and court materials for fee earners ahead of hearings
- Drafted and formatted correspondence and client notes; maintained structured matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, tracking each to resolution
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold and landlord and tenant issues to support fee earner advice

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Prepared, formatted and organised procedural documents — including procedural orders, procedural histories and sections of a Claimant's memorial — for a complex investment arbitration
- Reviewed and organised large evidence sets for procedural submissions; maintained structured electronic case files throughout
- Tracked procedural deadlines and outstanding actions; coordinated document flow when sole junior on the team ahead of a significant submission deadline
- Liaised with the client regarding required documents; coordinated with an external translator to manage Romanian-language materials
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **Legal Adviser**

July 2026 – Present

- Manages a high-volume caseload from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets firm deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes accurate chronologies
- Provides procedural guidance to clients, translating complex rules into clear, practical steps — particularly for vulnerable individuals
- Researches complex points of law and eligibility across multiple regulatory frameworks; identifies evidential gaps and next steps

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Drafted clear, commercially focused written advice translating complex statutory requirements into practical recommendations for the client
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to ensure timely delivery against a fixed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and flagged provisions requiring legal input
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Communicated amendments and queries to internal stakeholders across sales, legal and international business teams
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Document preparation and formatting; legal correspondence; iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and letter writing

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, evidence review and organisation, procedural document drafting, case-file management, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters